15 — Data retention and deletion policy

Français (version de référence) : ../fr/15-politique-conservation.md

> **TEMPLATE — TO VALIDATE.** Periods in brackets are proposals; the matching technical settings are given where they exist.

Header	
Jurisdiction	DRC — Digital Code (limited retention); OHADA (accounting records: 10 years)
Assumptions	H-03, H-14
Sources	S01, S15 — see 00-legal-research.md § 7
Clauses to validate	V-07
Version	[NUMBER] of [DATE]

1. Principle

Data is kept only as long as its purpose requires, then deleted or anonymised. Deletion also covers backups, which expire on their own cycle.

2. Periods

Data	Period	Implementation
Website submissions (not followed up)	[365] days	`SITE_RETENTION_DAYS`, daily purge (`nhill-site-purge.timer`)
IP fingerprint of form submissions	[30] days	`SITE_IP_RETENTION_DAYS`
Website anti-abuse counters	2 days	daily purge
Marketing consent	until withdrawal; proof of withdrawal [3] years	template 16; `cli unsubscribe`
A business's data (customers, sales, stock…)	contract term + [90] days of reversibility	export by the customer; deletion by operations
The business's accounting records	10 years **at the business's charge** (it exports its data)	CSV/PDF export
Subscription invoices issued by the Publisher	10 years	Publisher's accounting
Inactive user accounts	[24] months without sign-in → warning then deletion [TO DECIDE]	manual procedure
Audit and security log	at least [12] months, at most [5] years **[TO VALIDATE: V-07]**	—
Support requests	[24] months after closing	—
Database backups	rotation: [7] daily, [4] weekly, [12] monthly	`deploy/backup/`

Data	Period	Implementation
Server technical logs	[30] days	journald configuration

3. Deletion at the end of the contract

1. End of subscription → business read-only; the owner is invited to export its data.
2. D+[90] → deletion of the business's data from the production database; deletion recorded (date, operator) in the register.
3. D+[90] + backup rotation period → the data has disappeared from backups.
4. On request, written confirmation of deletion.

4. Erasure requests

Handled according to template 19, within [30] days, unless a legal retention obligation applies (then: limited retention, restricted access, and the person is informed).

5. Review

This policy is reviewed once a year and with every new processing (register, template 18).